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SERVICES

CASE STUDY

Cash Flow Visibility & Working Capital Transformation

Unlocking liquidity and de-risking growth through a 13-week rolling forecast and working capital discipline.

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Industry: Food manufacturer **Revenue:** INR 300 Cr **Engagement:** 8 to 12 weeks

The challenge

The client was navigating rapid growth alongside tightening liquidity. Strong top-line performance masked underlying cash strain, and leadership lacked the forward visibility needed to plan with confidence.

- Limited visibility into the near-term cash position, making it difficult to plan vendor payments, debt servicing and growth investments
- Stretched working capital cycles: receivables ageing beyond terms, inventory build-ups in slow-moving SKUs and inconsistent payable discipline
- Fragmented forecasting across Treasury, FP&A and Operations, in disconnected spreadsheets with inconsistent assumptions
- Reactive cash decisions: leadership often learned of shortfalls too late to negotiate favourable terms with lenders or suppliers

Our approach

1. **Diagnostic & baseline:** reviewed existing cash reporting, AR/AP/inventory policies and historical patterns to identify leakage and forecast gaps; interviewed Finance, Sales, Procurement and Operations to map the true cash cycle.

2. **13-week cash flow model build:** designed a dynamic, driver-based direct-method forecast integrated with long-range planning, with full scenario and sensitivity capability.
3. **Working capital optimisation:** diagnosed AR ageing and implemented tighter collection protocols; rationalised inventory through SKU-level analysis; standardised payment terms; introduced KPIs and a weekly cash review cadence.

Key deliverables

- **13-week rolling cash flow model:** direct-method forecast with weekly variance tracking, category-level receipts and payments view, and early-warning indicators
- **Working capital performance dashboard:** DSO, DPO, DIO and cash conversion cycle
- **Liquidity planning & scenario analysis:** base, upside and downside scenario modelling

All three tools were handed over to the client's Finance and Treasury teams with SOPs and enablement training.

Benefits delivered

₹85 lakh	28 days	95%	12 days
Working capital unlocked	Reduction in cash conversion cycle	Forecast accuracy (from ~75%)	Reduction in DSO

- **Forecast accuracy:** 13-week forecasts now track within ±5% of actuals, up from ±15 to 20% previously
- **Reporting efficiency:** weekly cash reporting reduced from 2 to 3 days to under half a day through automation
- **Board-ready reporting:** a single, reconciled weekly cash view enables proactive decisions on capex timing, debt paydown and supplier negotiations
- **Covenant headroom:** early liquidity visibility let the client pre-empt covenant tightness and renegotiate with lenders on favourable terms
- **Team capability:** Finance and Treasury teams trained to own, update and evolve the model post-handover

Client impact

What began as a cash visibility problem evolved into a broader finance transformation. The client now runs its business with a forward-looking cash lens, enabling confident investment decisions, stronger lender and supplier relationships, and a finance function that is truly a strategic partner to the business.

Case study details anonymised to protect client confidentiality. Figures reflect engagement outcomes; specifics available on request.

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